

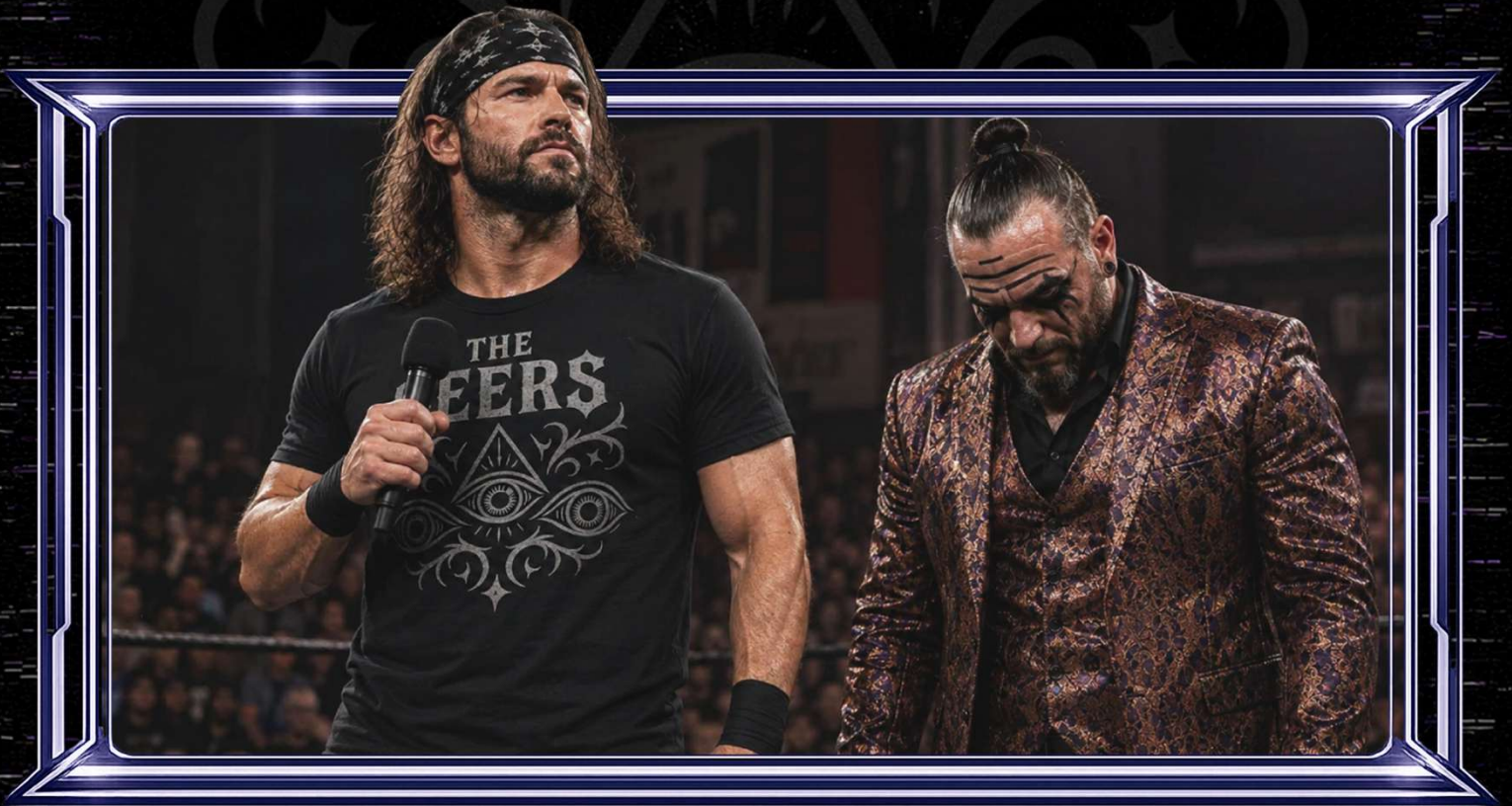
CFW BLACK LIGHT 40

The broadcast opens inside **The Foundry**. The camera sweeps across the crowd before settling on the ring, where **Ace Dalton** and **Ronnie Kixx** are already waiting.

Ronnie stands off to the side, shoulders slumped, his eyes fixed on the canvas. Ace is far more composed. He stands in the center of the ring with a microphone in hand, staring out into the crowd and fired up Foundry.

Bert McDaniels: "Welcome to Black Light 40. We are coming off a chaotic night at AFTERBURN, where Adam Stryker ended Ace Dalton's reign and became the new CFW World Champion."

Ace looks slightly annoyed. His expression is downright angry.



ACE DALTON

RONNIE KIXX

OPENING SEGMENT
**ACE DALTON WITH
RONNIE KIXX**



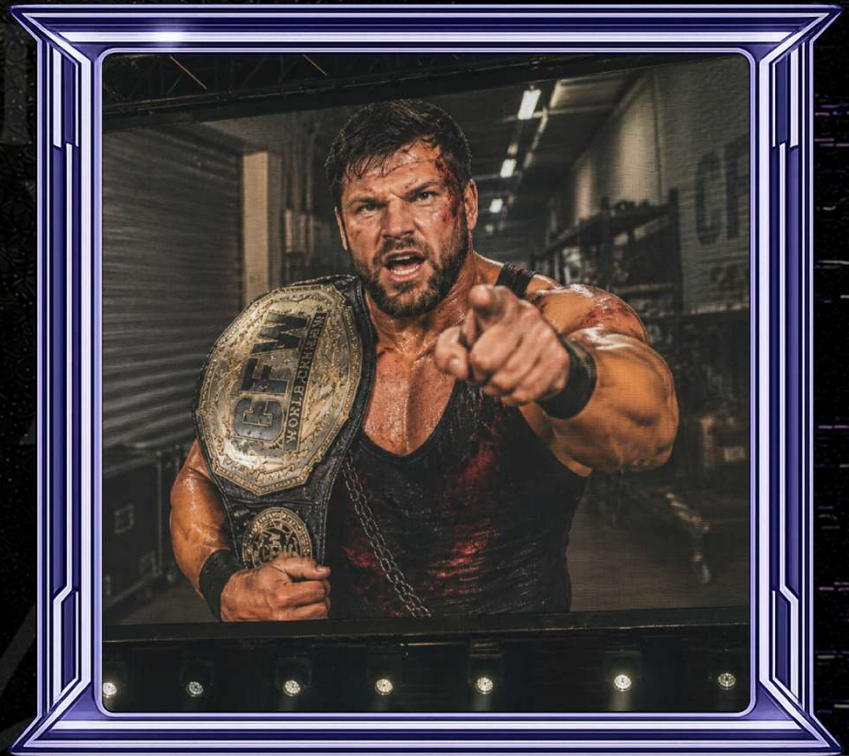
The camera moves tighter on Ace. His expression doesn't change.

Bert McDaniels: "And immediately after that match, Stryker had a few words for the former champion... and The Seers."

Ace turns his attention toward the screen.

Bert McDaniels: "Take a look."

Adam Stryker stands battered from the match, the **CFW World Championship** resting proudly over his shoulder.

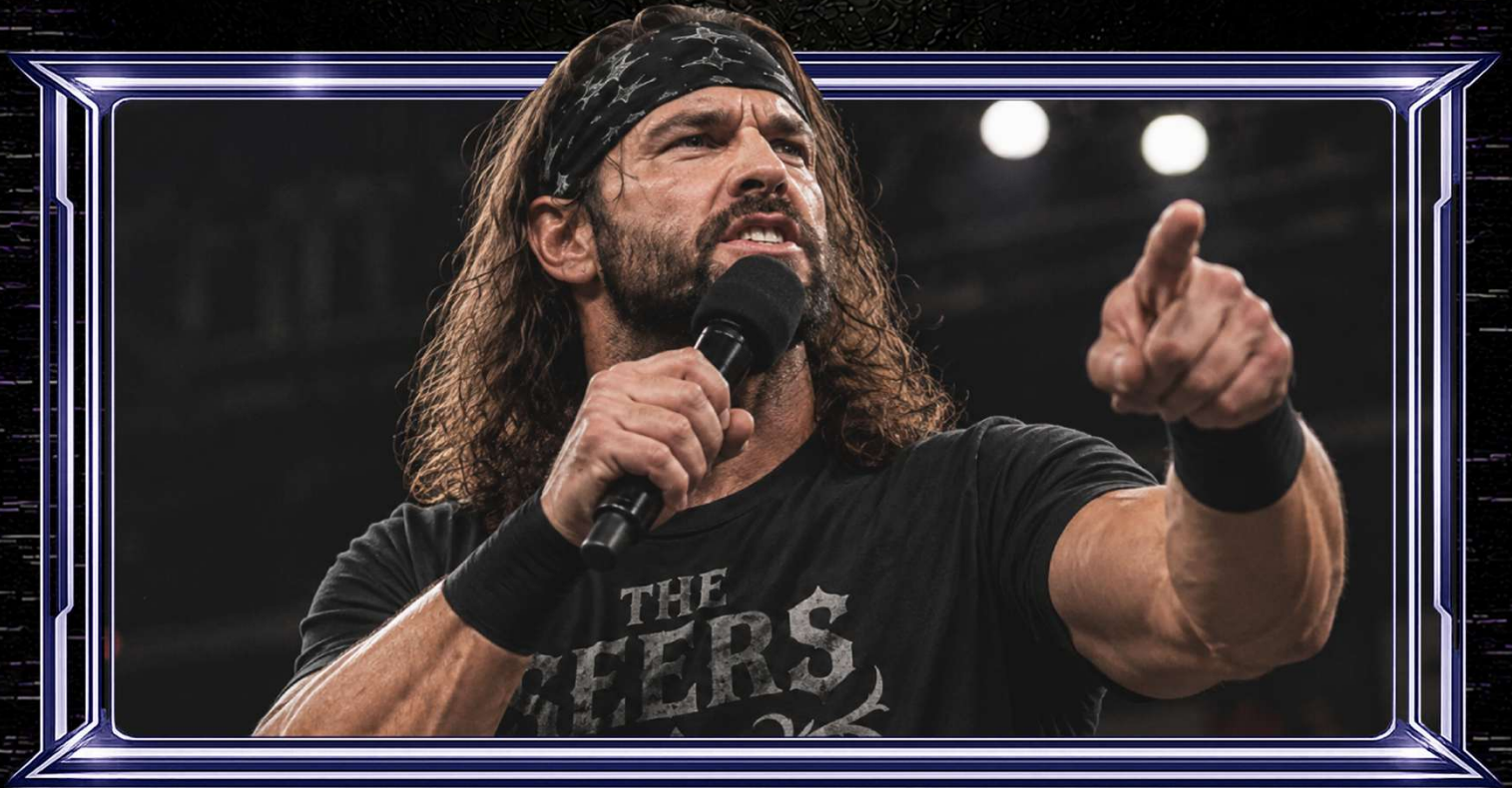


A D A M S T R Y K E R

Adam Stryker: "Just like every time, Adam Stryker did EXACTLY what he said he'd do!" Stryker pats the championship. "SEVEN time world champion my friends. After Ace Dalton and The Seers tried to kick me out of CFW, after they damn near killed me in the ring or that one time in Venice Beach... I gave them, and Ace especially, a taste of their own medicine and took the only thing that made them relevant." Quick cut. "Maybe there are shortcuts, maybe there are desperate measures... But that desperation for success is what made me a champion over and over again. So I won't break that formula." One final cut. Stryker adjusts the championship on his shoulder. "So Ace, if you or any of your freaky buddies want a shot at this, take your place in the back of the line now. And MAR, old pal, whatever your appearance tonight was supposed to mean... Just stay out of my way." Stryker raises the championship. "The era of The Seers is over, no matter what their golden child or their **long lost daddy** have to say about it."

The screen cuts to black.

OPENING SEGMENT
**ACE DALTON WITH
RONNIE KIXX**



Back inside The Foundry, the camera settles on Ace. He slowly raises the microphone...

Crowd: "LONG LOST DADDY!" *CLAP! CLAP! CLAP-CLAP-CLAP!*

Crowd: "LONG LOST DADDY!" *CLAP! CLAP! CLAP-CLAP-CLAP!*

Ace suddenly snaps the microphone to his mouth.

Ace Dalton: "THIS! This right here is the problem!" The chant quickly turns to boos. "This is the problem with you people. This is the problem with Adam Stryker. You don't know who the hell you're dealing with." Ace points toward the screen. "And unfortunately, that's the nature of what we are. Adam Stryker doesn't know who MAR is. He doesn't know who The Seers are. He doesn't know what this company means. He doesn't know what that championship means." Ace pauses, shaking his head. "But he likes to shoot his mouth off like he does."

The crowd boos louder. Ace looks toward Ronnie before turning back to them.

OPENING SEGMENT
ACE DALTON WITH
RONNIE KIXX



Ace Dalton: "Misunderstanding MAR? That's forgivable. Hell, I misunderstood MAR for a long time. So Adam, I can forgive you for that." His expression hardens. "What I won't forgive is the disrespect." Ace steps toward the ropes, staring directly into the hard camera. "If you have no idea who that man is... if you have no idea what he's sacrificed... then shut the hell up." The Foundry erupts.

Crowd: "BOOOOOOOOOO!"

Ace lowers the microphone and looks around at them with disgust. Ronnie remains silent behind him. Ace waits for the noise to settle before continuing, his voice quieter now.

Ace Dalton: "Adam Stryker doesn't know MAR." A pause. "But Adam Stryker knows Ace Dalton." Ace points to himself. "You know exactly who the hell I am." His composure begins to crack again. "I'm the man you couldn't beat." The crowd reacts. "Go home, Adam. Put that championship on the table. Stand in front of a mirror and look yourself in the eyes." Ace moves closer to the camera. "And tell yourself the truth." A beat. "That man looking back at you couldn't beat Ace Dalton." Ace's jaw tightens. "Not without wrapping a rope around my neck." A roar rolls through The Foundry. "You admitted it yourself. Shortcuts. Desperate measures. You said desperation is what made you a champion over and over again." Ace gives a small nod. "I believe you." He lets that hang. "Because that's the difference between you and me, Adam." Ace points toward the screen again. "Desperation is your formula." He brings the microphone closer, almost speaking through gritted teeth. "For me?"

A pause. "It's an option."

Ace lets those words sit for a moment.

Ace Dalton: "And maybe I've spent too much time expecting people like you to understand what The Seers are."

The anger begins to leave his voice. Something colder replaces it.

OPENING SEGMENT
ACE DALTON WITH
RONNIE KIXX



Ace Dalton: "So right here, right now, as the man who leads The Seers... I don't need to speak in riddles." Ace glances toward Ronnie. "I don't need to hide behind prophecy. I don't need to give you any more of that wind talk bullshit."

Ace turns back toward the hard camera.

Ace Dalton: "I'll make you a promise instead." A pause. "The Seers will hold gold again sooner than any of you realize."

The crowd reacts, but Ace doesn't acknowledge them.

Ace Dalton: "And Adam..." His eyes narrow. "When that impostor syndrome finally gets the best of you—and it will—when you're lying awake staring at that championship wondering if you can actually beat me..." Ace steps closer to the camera.

Ace Dalton: "Come find out."

A pause.

Ace Dalton: "Or don't wait. Tomorrow. Next week. Anytime you muster enough courage to need the answer." Ace's jaw tightens. "I'll stand toe-to-toe with your delusional ass and give it to you."

He stares directly into the camera.

Ace Dalton: "You didn't end the era of The Seers."

A pause.

Ace Dalton: "You just made yourself part of it." Ace's expression goes cold.

Ace Dalton: "And when the time comes..."

He points toward the blank screen where Stryker was shown moments earlier.

Ace Dalton: "...I'm taking back what belongs to us."